

MultipleWindowsFolders

Open a list of folders as tabs in a single File Explorer window on Windows 11 -- with one double-click.

QUICK START

1. Open OpenFoldersAsTabs.py and edit the folder list at the top
2. Double-click "OpenFoldersAsTabs_Python.bat"
3. Don't touch your keyboard or mouse until the Explorer window finishes loading all tabs (~6 sec per tab)

That's it. The console window closes automatically when done.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

OpenFoldersAsTabs.py	Main script. Opens folders as tabs in one Explorer window.
OpenFoldersAsTabs_Python.bat	Double-click launcher for the .py.
archive-ps1/	Archived PowerShell approach (.ps1 scripts and their .bat launchers).

EDITING THE FOLDER LIST

Open OpenFoldersAsTabs.py and edit the FOLDERS list:

```
_home = os.path.expandvars("%USERPROFILE%")
FOLDERS = [
    os.path.join(_home, "Downloads"),
    os.path.join(_home, "OneDrive", "ObsidianVault"),
    os.path.join(_home, "OneDrive", "ObsidianVault", "Vault"),
    os.path.join(_home, "OneDrive", "ObsidianVault", "Projects"),
]
```

Paths use %USERPROFILE% via os.path.expandvars so the script is portable across accounts.

REQUIREMENTS

- Windows 11 -- Explorer tabs are a Windows 11 feature. On Windows 10 you'll get separate windows instead.
- Python 3 with the pywin32 package:

```
pip install pywin32
```

HOW IT WORKS

Windows has no command-line API for opening Explorer tabs, so the script simulates it:

1. Opens the first folder in a normal Explorer window
2. Detects the new window by its handle (HWND) -- comparing window lists before/after launch
3. For each additional folder:
 - Sets the clipboard to the folder path

- Sends Ctrl+T -> new tab
 - Sends Alt+D -> focuses the address bar
 - Sends Ctrl+V -> pastes the path
 - Sends Enter -> navigates
4. Restores your original clipboard contents when done
 5. Closes the launcher's console window automatically

Focus is enforced between each step using Win32 AttachThreadInput + SetForegroundWindow, which is more reliable than basic SetForegroundWindow alone (Windows blocks background apps from stealing focus by default).

TROUBLESHOOTING

- A tab opens but shows "Home" instead of the folder:

Increase the `time.sleep` delays in the script. The 3-second pauses after Ctrl+T and Enter are the most important ones.

- The script opens separate windows instead of tabs:

Make sure you're on Windows 11 with Explorer tabs enabled (it's on by default).

- Nothing happens when double-clicking the .bat:

Right-click -> Run as administrator, or run the Python command manually.

- Python errors on import:

Run `"pip install pywin32"` first.

TIPS

- Pin the .bat to your taskbar or Start menu for one-click access.

- Add more folder lists: duplicate the .py and .bat with different names and folder lists for different workflows (e.g., WorkFolders.bat, ProjectFolders.bat).

- Don't interact with the keyboard or mouse while the script runs -- it uses simulated keystrokes that need Explorer to stay in focus.